

University of Stuttgart – Information sheet

You are invited to participate in a research study of the process of reading and comprehending English sentences carried out online.

We ask you to read this form before agreeing to participate in the study.
The study is conducted by Takumi Kobayashi affiliated to the University of Stuttgart (Germany).

Study purposes and recruitment procedure

The goal of the current study is to investigate how people read and understand English sentences in real time. Participants were recruited through convenience sampling, including personal contacts and the online research platform Prolific.

The procedure strictly conforms to the voluntary nature of the study, and participants take part in the experiment voluntarily via an online platform.

Procedures for the study

The experimental study consists of an online self-paced reading task in which participants read English sentences displayed in small chunks, pressing the space bar to read chunk by chunk. After reading each sentence, participants answer a Yes/No question.
The entire trial takes approximately 20-30 minutes and can be completed on a personal computer.

Risks and benefits of taking part in the study

This experimental procedure is widely used in linguistics and psycholinguistics. The experiment poses no risk to humans. It is non-invasive and non-discomforting. It does not involve any sort of deception. It strictly conforms to the rules and regulations that are in accordance with national, EU and international laws.

The task of the participant is to read English sentences and answer the Yes/No comprehension question after each sentence. The materials are not offensive and represent what the participant may encounter in their life on a daily basis.

The participant has the right to ask as many questions as they wish before giving consent to participate. They have the right to terminate the experiment at any time without providing a reason. Leaving the study will not result in any penalty or loss of benefits to which you are entitled.

The data collected in the study will be used for academic purposes only. The results will form a part of a master's thesis and possibly be presented at a scientific conference and published in an academic journal.

The participant can be informed about those publications if they wish to.
The participant will receive monetary compensation for taking part in the study.

Confidentiality

Before taking part in the study, the participant will be asked to fill in a questionnaire on the online experiment web page.

The questionnaire only comprises personal information essential to the research objectives of the proposed project, namely: age, current residence, language and academic background and so on.

The collected data will be securely stored on the PCIBex online platform during data collection and subsequently transferred to a password-protected computer for analysis. The data will be stored anonymously and confidentially on a password-protected computer.

The personal data will be kept until the completion of the project, including the master's thesis and any related publications. If the participant decides to terminate the experiment earlier, the data will be immediately deleted.

Contacts for further questions and/or problems

For questions about the study, contact Takumi Kobayashi at takumikobayashi0304@gmail.com.